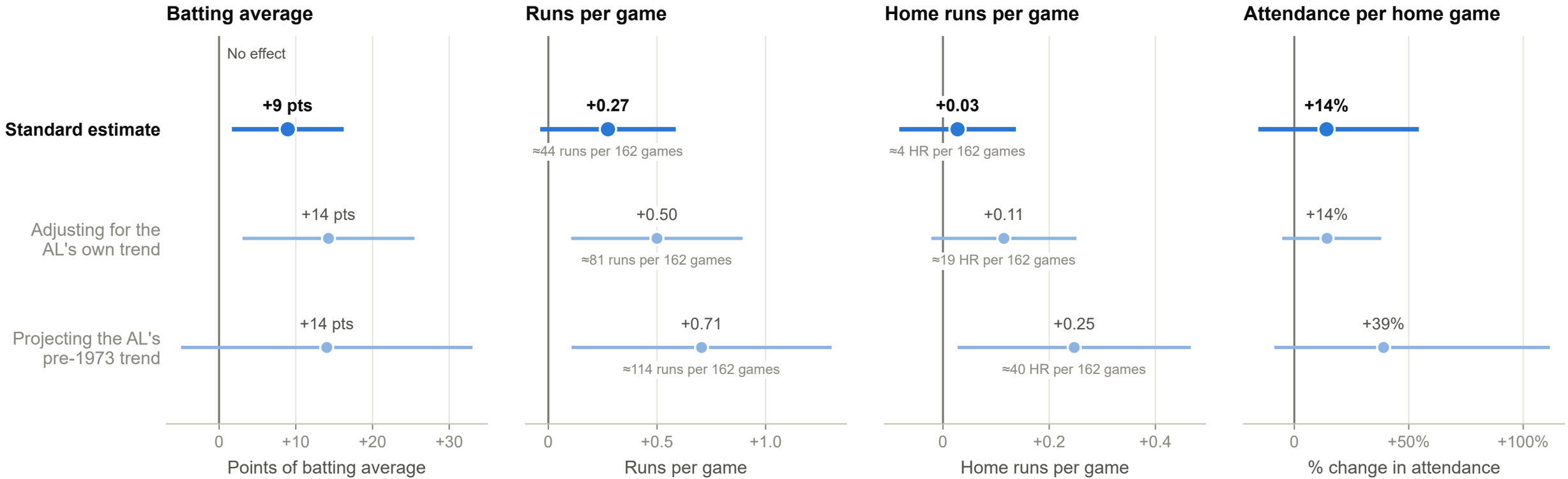
The standard estimate shows a clear DH boost only for AL batting average

Estimated effect of the DH on AL teams, 1973–1976, under three approaches. Dots are estimates; bars show 95% confidence intervals. Adjusting for the AL's pre-1973 decline makes every hitting effect larger; the attendance effect is uncertain under every approach.



Source: SABR Lahman Baseball Database (2025). Notes: Standard estimate: regression with team and year fixed effects, 1969–1976 (192 team-seasons). "Adjusting for the AL's own trend" adds a separate straight-line AL trend fit to all eight seasons. "Projecting the AL's pre-1973 trend" fits that line to 1969–72 only and averages how far 1973–76 sit above its projection; because AL hitting dipped in 1972, this projection slopes down and may overstate the effect. Intervals clustered by franchise (24 clusters). Batting average in points (1 point = .001); attendance converted from log points to percent with exp(b) − 1; per-162-game figures multiply the per-game effect by 162.